

55.4 KEY LANGUAGE COUNTABLE AND UNCOUNTABLE ABSTRACT NOUNS

Some abstract nouns have both countable and uncountable forms. The forms have a slight difference in meaning, with the countable form being specific and the uncountable form being more general.

COUNTABLE

I've been there a few **times**.

Each "time" is a specific occasion.

He has had many **successes**.

"Successes" are the specific achievements.

She has some great **qualities**.

"Qualities" refers to features of her character.

We learned several new **skills**.

These are the particular abilities learned.



UNCOUNTABLE

There's plenty of **time** left.

"Time" refers to the concept in general.

Hard work leads to **success**.

"Success" refers to achievement in general.

It has a reputation for **quality**.

"Quality" refers to a high standard.

It takes **skill** to do that job.

"Skill" is the general ability to do something.



55.5 CROSS OUT THE INCORRECT WORD IN EACH SENTENCE

The top four racing drivers have very similar average **speed** / **speeds**.

- ① She was deep in **thought** / **thoughts** so we did not disturb her.
- ② In college, you can meet people from many different **culture** / **cultures**.
- ③ My father formed many lasting **friendship** / **friendships** in college.
- ④ This house is amazing. There are so many interesting **space** / **spaces**.
- ⑤ My brother does a lot of work for several local **charity** / **charities**.
- ⑥ Apparently, this is the worst weather in living **memory** / **memories**.
- ⑦ In these difficult times it's so important not to give up **hope** / **hopes**.

